



## Escaping the war

GIs exchange heroin vials in a decorated bunk in Vietnam. Opium and heroin were cheap, and of a high quality, but used primarily in secure areas because their narcotic effect could get the user killed.

### » AFTER

**Studies of Vietnam veterans indicated that drug use primarily stemmed from combat exposure and that 90 percent of veterans stopped using drugs upon their return to the United States.**

### NEGATIVE IMAGES

Although the Nixon administration tried to downplay the military's concerns about drug use, **popular stereotypes** began to emerge back home of service members as "potheads" and drug addicts. These images were inaccurate overall, but sadly heroin addiction did afflict many **returning service men and women**, who often struggled to get the help they needed.